

Prof. Antonio Capone
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29 May 2026

Subject: Letter of Support for the PRIN 2026 GridAI – GReen Itinerant Distributed AI Project

Dear Professor Capone

The University of Würzburg, through its Chair of Communication Networks, is pleased to express its support to the research project “GridAI – GReen Itinerant Distributed AI”, submitted by the consortium coordinated by Politecnico di Milano under the PRIN 2026 (Linea Principale) call of the Italian Ministry of University and Research.

The Chair of Communication Networks at the University of Würzburg is a major German academic group in computer communication networks, network performance analysis and emerging Internet architectures, with established research output in network telemetry, traffic engineering and the environmental and energy dimensions of large-scale networked systems. The subject of the project, namely the geographical and temporal mobility of artificial intelligence workloads in order to follow renewable energy availability and reduce the pressure on the electrical transmission infrastructure, lies in close continuity with our current research agenda.

A scientific collaboration with the GridAI consortium, in particular with the research group of Prof. Stefano Salsano at the University of Rome “Tor Vergata”, is currently active on the convergent themes of geographically distributed AI workloads, data-versus-energy trade-offs and the time-versus-space orchestration of compute under renewable constraints. This collaboration is concretely anchored on the recent IFIP Networking 2026 paper by Baur, Paulus, Loh, Rudion and Hoßfeld on the integration of data centres and the German energy grid through geographic load shifting, which converges on the same conceptual axes that the GridAI framework formalises.

We consider that the formulation proposed by the consortium, articulated around the concept of nomadic AI compute and the equivalence principle between electrical storage and acceleration of deferrable computation, represents a methodologically original direction with potentially high impact relative to the approaches currently prevailing at the European level, which are mainly focused on extending the HVDC backbone. The opportunity to engage on these themes with an Italian-led consortium that brings a complementary perspective on the orchestration and certification of nomadic AI workloads is of significant value for our research agenda.

We therefore confirm our interest in following the developments of the project and, consistently with the existing collaboration and in compliance with our internal policies, in considering additional forms of technical cooperation and exchange of experience and data on topics of mutual interest in the subsequent development phases.

Best regards,



Prof. Dr. Tobias Hoßfeld, Head of
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University of Würzburg
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